



REGENERATIVE EDEN · COMPANION PLANTING

BENJY'S MEDITERRANEAN PLANTING CHART

What to plant together in heavily-mulched, log-edge beds —
summer crops, companions, feeding & a moon-planting primer.

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*Plants, like people, thrive in good company.
Put the right ones together and they protect, feed,
and lift each other — a living community in every bed.*

HOW TO USE THIS CHART

Find your crop, plant its good companions nearby, keep the antagonists apart, and follow the feeding & timing tips. Everything here is tuned for dry Mediterranean gardens with deep mulch and rich, log-edge beds. Drawn from the great permaculture & companion-planting traditions, tested on our Algarve land.



01 · THE COMPANION CHART

Who loves whom.



CROP	PLANT WITH ✓	KEEP APART ×	QUICK TIP
Tomatoes	Basil, marigold, borage, carrots, parsley, chives, lettuce (in shade)	Potatoes, fennel, brassicas (chard, kale)	Basil = flavour + pest guard. Stake well. Hungry feeder — rich compost + manure.
Peppers & chillies	Basil, marigold, nasturtium, onions, carrots, oregano	Fennel, beans (keep modest)	Love heat & the warmest spot. Same care as tomatoes.
Cucumbers	Beans, nasturtium, dill, borage, sunflower/corn (to climb)	Potatoes, sage, strong herbs	Trellis up for airflow. Thirsty — deep water, deep mulch.
Beans (bush & pole)	Cucumbers, chard, celery, carrots, corn, sunflower	Onions, garlic, chives, leeks	Nitrogen-fixer — feeds neighbours. Don't over-feed N.
Chard / silverbeet	Beans, onions, celery, parsley	Tomatoes	Loves afternoon shade in summer. Steady moisture.
Celery	Beans, leeks, tomatoes, brassicas, parsley	Carrots (mild)	Part shade + constant moisture is essential. Heavy feeder.
Parsley	Tomatoes, asparagus, chives, peppers	—	Part shade in heat or it bolts. Attracts hoverflies.
Coriander	Spinach, chard, beans, dill	Fennel	Bolts fast in sun — part shade. Sow little & often.

✿ **BENJY'S GOLDEN PAIRS.** Tomato + basil + marigold · Cucumber + beans + nasturtium · Celery + chard + parsley in the shade · Beans climbing corn or sunflower. Plant these together and watch them thrive.

02 · FLOWERS & GUILDS

The helpers & the teams.



✿ Which flower, and why

FLOWER	WHY PLANT IT
Marigold (<i>Tagetes</i>)	#1 for tomatoes & peppers. Roots deter nematodes, scent confuses aphids & whitefly.
Nasturtium	Aphid trap crop — sacrificial magnet. Edible, living groundcover. Plant at edges.
Calendula	Sticky leaves catch aphids, feeds pollinators, edible, self-seeds everywhere.
Cosmos	Beautiful pollinator & hoverfly magnet. More beauty than protection — plant freely.
Borage	Bee magnet, tomato/squash booster, soft chop-and-drop biomass, edible flowers.

🌿 Classic summer guilds (plant as teams)

GUILD	THE TEAM
Three Sisters	Corn + climbing beans + squash. Corn = pole, beans = nitrogen, squash = living mulch.
The Tomato Family	Tomato + basil + marigold + borage, lettuce tucked in the shade.
The Cucumber Patch	Cucumber + beans + nasturtium + dill + a sunflower to climb.
The Shade Pocket	Celery + chard + parsley + coriander — cool, moist, part shade.
The Pepper Trio	Peppers + basil + onions, marigold on the edge.

03 · WHEN TO PLANT

June · July · August.



JUNE	Transplant (last window): tomatoes, peppers, aubergine, basil. Direct sow: cucumber, courgette, squash, melon, beans, corn, sweet potato slips, amaranth, chard. Sow biomass: pigeon pea, sorghum, sunn hemp, tithonia.
JULY	Keep sowing: beans, cucumber, fast greens & coriander in shade, more chard. Do: chop-and-drop biomass for mulch, succession-sow lettuce in shade, start autumn brassica seedlings in trays (in shade), water deep & early.
AUGUST	Sow autumn/winter: brassicas, carrots, beetroot, leeks, kale, spinach (in shade), more coriander & parsley. Do: keep mulch thick, final chop-and-drop, plan the cool-season beds.

 The shade rule for Mediterranean summer

Plant tall sun-lovers (corn, sunflower, sorghum, tithonia) on the **south & west** side of your beds. Their afternoon shadow becomes a cool nursery for lettuce, chard, celery and coriander — the tender ones that bolt or scorch in full August sun.

04 • FEED THE SOIL

What each bed wants.



In a rich, mulched, log-edge bed most feeding is already done by the soil life. But heavy feeders love a boost. Always feed the *soil*, not just the plant.

✿ Who's hungry?

GROUP	WHAT THEY NEED
Heavy feeders	Tomatoes, peppers, cucumbers, squash, corn, celery. Give rich compost + aged manure at planting, liquid feed through the season.
Light feeders	Beans, peas (they FEED the soil), herbs, lettuce. Little extra needed.
Leafy greens	Chard, spinach, kale. Like nitrogen — compost + a comfrey/manure tea boost.

✦ The amendments (and why)

AMENDMENT	ROLE & DOSE
Aged manure (horse/cow)	Gentle, balanced base feed + moisture. Age 2–3 months. Cow = cool, horse = fibrous & biological.
Chicken manure	HOT, high nitrogen — powerful for leafy & heavy feeders. Age 3–6 months, use thin.
Worm castings	A handful per transplant — instant biology, humic acids & root hormones. Gardener's gold.
Volcanic basalt rock dust	70+ trace minerals, slow release for years. A handful per hole. (Grow It / Sementes Vivas)
Charged biochar	Long-term carbon home for microbes. Always charge first. Up to 5–10% of bed volume.
Comfrey / nettle tea	Free liquid feed. Dilute 1:10, water in every 2–3 weeks. Potassium for fruit & flower.

* **BENJY'S PLANTING-HOLE RITUAL.** Into each hole: a handful of worm castings + a handful of basalt + a pinch of mycorrhizae on the roots. Backfill, water with diluted seaweed or comfrey tea, tuck the mulch back. That's a thriving plant from day one.

05 · PLANTING WITH THE MOON

A gentle primer.



Biodynamic growers (following Maria Thun & Rudolf Steiner) plant in rhythm with the moon as it passes the constellations. Each day favours one part of the plant. You don't have to — but many feel their gardens grow stronger when they do. The simple version:

MOON DAY	WHAT TO PLANT
Root days (Earth)	Sow & harvest roots: carrots, beetroot, radish, potato, garlic, onion.
Leaf days (Water)	Sow & tend leafy crops: lettuce, chard, spinach, cabbage, herbs. (Avoid for fruit-setting.)
Flower days (Air)	Sow flowers & broccoli; cut flowers. Lovely for pollinator plants.
Fruit / seed days (Fire)	BEST for tomatoes, peppers, cucumbers, beans, squash, corn — all the fruiting summer crops.

☾ **THE EASY WAY.** Most of your summer crops (tomatoes, peppers, cucumbers, beans) are **fruit crops** — so sow them on **Fruit days**. Plant chard, lettuce & herbs on **Leaf days**. For exact dates, search a free online *biodynamic / moon planting calendar* for your month, or use an app like 'Moon & Garden'. A waxing moon (toward full) is also a classic time to sow above-ground crops.

*"Plant in good company, feed the soil not the plant,
give the tender ones shade, and when you can —
sow in rhythm with the moon. The garden will sing."*

✿ NEED HELP WITH YOUR GARDEN? ✿

Benjy & Sofia help you bring your land alive — wherever you are on the journey.

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Much love, everyone — from our hands to your soil.

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